Game Design Concept and Pitch Template

This is a skeleton/reference for your game design concept. Fill it in with details about your game idea, but please keep it relatively brief!

Name: **Connor Moran**

High Level Concept / Design

1. Working Title(s) (Optional)

Your game's title should communicate the gameplay and the style of the game.

| **Pharmacritical**

2. Concept Statement

The game in a tweet: one or two sentences at most that say what the game is and why it's fun.

| **Papers Please, but instead you're an overworked pharmacist who has to**
| **find the correct medicine for the customer.**

3. Genre(s)

Single genres are easier but often less interesting. Genre combinations can be risky. Beware of 'tired' genres. Please see the approved list when choosing your genre.

| **Puzzle, Simulation, Management**

4. Similar Games **(Critical)**

What games are similar to yours that are currently on the market? What aspects of your game are similar to them, and what aspects differ that make it unique?

| **Papers Please - Document checking, but not just approving or denying entry**
| **Lil' Guardsman - Investigation, but no exploration, more focused**
| **Wilmot's Warehouse - Stock management, but more detailed**

5. Target Audience PEGI Ratings Guide ESRB Ratings Guide

Motivations and relevant interests; potentially age, gender, etc.; You're free to choose almost any topics, so violence and drugs are acceptable, but sexual content will be rejected. Aim for below 18+ as a PEGI/ESRB rating for the game.

| **PEGI 12 / ESRB Teen - Use of drugs, references to sexual activity in a medical**
| **context**

6. Unique Selling Points **(Critical)**

What makes your game stand out? How is it different from all other games?

| **Many games of this genre seem to focus on just allowing or denying entry to**
| **somewhere. This allows for a more puzzle solving mechanic where there are**
| **multiple answers, and outcomes depending on your choices.**

7. Player Experience and Game POV

Who is the player? What is the setting? What is the fantasy the game grants the player? What emotions do you want the player to feel? What keeps the player engaged for the duration of their play?

| The player is an overworked trainee pharmacist, in a run down pharmacy.
| The player initially supposed to harbour good intentions, trying to do right by
| the customer. But as more complex requirements come into play they may
| take shortcuts and such, giving them pressure and stress. Engagement comes
| from trying to balance the puzzle, and morality of their choices.

8. Visual and Audio Style

What is the "look and feel" of the game? How does this support the desired player's experience? (Please add concept sketches and mood board images later on in the document.)

| The game look is supposed to be a little cartoony, but stylised. The look
| of Papers Please and Not Tonight is appealing but in this pixel graphics aren't
| used. They can be, but this needs to be decided on. (à la Buckshot Roulette)
| By having a more 3D environment, objects can have dimensions to interact
| with.

9. Game World Fiction

Briefly describe the game world and any narrative in player-relevant terms (as presented to the player).

| The game world the player finds themselves in is rough, and grotty.
| The place the player works is understaffed and decrepit as it falls apart
| from lack of government funding. It is supposed to mirror the state of the
| UKs NHS. (But this isn't said explicitly)
| Over time, the player may be able to work towards a better future.

10. Platform(s), Technology, and Scope

This game will be on PC, and if time allows, will be ported to other consoles. What dimensions will your game be in, 2D or 2.5D? What are the major risks?

2D games will only contain 2D assets, regardless of perspective.
2.5D games are any game that uses 2D and 3D assets together, but no navigable 3D world.
3D games are generally not within the scope, if your game is 3D please explain how you can keep the scope small. 3D game concepts have a high chance of being rejected.

| 2.5D, the game will have 3D objects that can be interacted with and inspected
| but in a mostly 2D environment.
| Risks come from trying to make systems that allow for fine detail and object
| interaction, such as object manipulation and data comparison.
|

11. Core Loops

How do game objects and the player's actions form loops? Why is this engaging? How does this support player goals? What emergent results do you expect/hope to see?

| The game is separated into days and levels, where each couple of days the
| requirements become more and more complex. Based around Paper's Please,
| the player is expected to keep track of even more mundane banal rules, with
| a slip up harming a patient, or possibly even causing death.
| The better they perform, the better their progression, which might push them
| into making shortcuts. Whether they do is up to them.

12. Objectives and Progression

How does the player move through the game, literally and figuratively, from tutorial to end? What are their short-term and long-term goals (explicit or implicit)? How do these support the game concept, style, and player-fantasy?

| The player starts with a senior staff member explaining briefly what to do,
| but most of the game has to be worked out by the player, The short-term
| goal is to get to the end of each day, but the long-term goal is to successfully
| become a better pharmacist and possibly work in a better area.

13. Game Systems (Critical)

What systems are needed to make this game? What mechanics does your game have? Which ones are internal (simulation, etc.) and which does the player interact with?

| Object interaction system - So that objects can be freely interacted with and
| manipulated in 3D space so players can investigate them.
| Dialogue system - So that players have a dialogue tree they can use to talk
| to customers with and ask questions to figure out the best option for them.
| Database system - A list of the medicines in the game with linked information
| so that they can be cross-referenced with the player's solution.

14. Interactivity

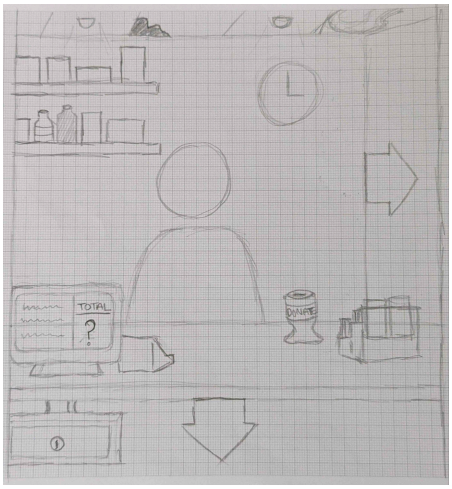
How are different kinds of interactivity used? (Action/Feedback, Cerebral, Emotional, Social, Cultural) What is the player doing moment-by-moment? How does the player move through the world? How does physics/combat/etc. work? A clear example or sketch of the primary game UX is helpful.

| The player navigates the limited environment by clicking the edges of the
| screen, and interacts with the world by inspecting documents and different
| objects, usually medicines, to work out the correct answer.
| There is little in the way of game UI, with the player interacting mostly
| in a cerebral and emotional manner.

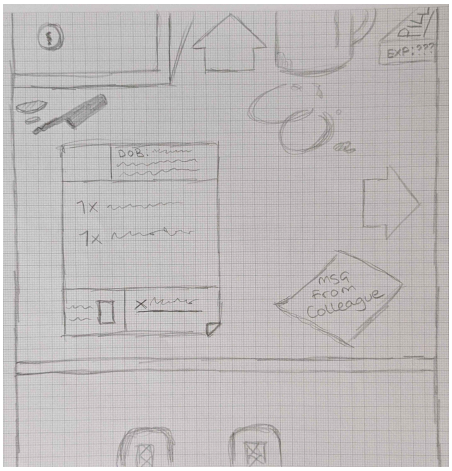
15. Concept Sketches (Optional)

Give some rough sketches of some example scenes in your game to give a general overview of what your game looks like. You can also draw out your game mechanics to better explain what you mean. You can either place them below or provide uploaded links.
Add comments with each to indicate what your sketch is trying to show.

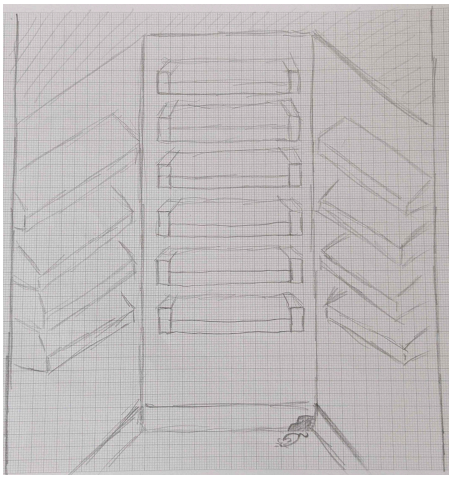
This sketch shows the first screen of the game, where the player is able to ask the customer questions, such as if they have a prescription, how they're feeling, do they have any conditions the player should be aware of, so on.
Other aspects of the background can come into play as well, such as being the only screen the player can see how much time is remaining in their shift and such.



This sketch shows the second screen, the players desk and workspace. This is the area a player can pick up documents the customer has offered to inspect them and see and further information they need. It is also the space the player takes medication that they have taken from the stock area, and can divide up the dosage they are providing the customer.



This sketch shows the third and final screen, the stock and storage area for medicines.
Each shelf can be selected the zoom into it, and then each rack can be pulled out to see what medicines are available. The player is able to freely organise this space as they wish, and use whatever organisational system that they can think of.



16. Mood Board (Critical)

Provide some images to give ideas of your concept. This can be for the art style, game perspective, mechanics, and so on. These can be from anywhere, such as from Google or Reddit or so on. You can either place them below or provide uploaded links. Add comments with each to indicate what each image is trying to show.